DAILY ACTIVE RECALL · MASTER MATRIX & FACTS

UTTAR PRADESH SPECIAL GK

उत्तर प्रदेश विशेष सामान्य ज्ञान — उच्च-प्राथमिकता पुनरावलोकन

Geographic Boundaries & 4 Extremes, Drainage & Rivers, Dudhwa NP & 4 Tiger Reserves, 10 Ramsar Sites, 9 Agro-Climatic Zones, Minerals, 1857 Revolt, Gharanas, and 75 Districts ODOP.

High-Yield Ratta Matrix
Concentrated prelims facts, tables & comparisons

Examiner Trap Eliminators
Confused pairs and high-frequency exam traps

15–20 Min Daily Read
Formulated for active morning memory drills

Exam-Aligned Coverage
Curated strictly for UPPSC Prelims, RO/ARO & BEO

UP-PCS & UK-PCS Examination Resource
General Studies Paper 1 · Prelims Fast-Recall Desk

Daily Revision Master Edition · 2026
Nitish Pratap Official Library

Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts (UP Special GK)

★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Daily Fact Dump · Active Recall Cheat-Sheet

> **Exam Focus:** UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO, UP Police SI
> **Frequency:** Daily morning read (15–20 mins)
> **Question Types Covered:** UP Geography & Borders, District Extremes, Rivers, Lakes & Canals, Wildlife Sanctuaries, Tiger Reserves, Ramsar Wetlands, 9 Agro-Climatic Zones, Minerals & Industrial Belts, Historical 1857 Centres & Leaders, Cultural Gharanas & Folk Dances, All 75 Districts ODOP & GI Tags, Major Expressways & Industrial Corridors.

1. Uttar Pradesh Geographical Profile & Boundary Matrix

Geographical Dimension	Exact Specification & Measurement	High-Yield Prelims Anchor
Latitudinal Extent	$23^{\circ} 52'\text{ N}$ to $30^{\circ} 24'\text{ N}$	Latitudinal span: $6^{\circ} 32'$
Longitudinal Extent	$77^{\circ} 05'\text{ E}$ to $84^{\circ} 38'\text{ E}$	Longitudinal span: $7^{\circ} 33'$
Standard Time Meridian	**$82^{\circ} 30'\text{ E}$ (IST)** passes through **Mirzapur (near Prayagraj)**	Calculates Indian Standard Time (GMT $+5:30$)
Total Geographic Area	**240,928 sq km** (7.33% of India's total area)	**4th Largest State** by area (Rajasthan > MP > Maharashtra > UP)
East-to-West Length	**650 km**	Extreme length
North-to-South Width	**240 km**	Narrower width
Number of Neighboring Entities	**8 States + 1 UT (Delhi) + 1 International (Nepal)**	Shares borders with the **maximum number of states** in India

Boundary Touch-Points Master Grid

- **Northern Boundary:** Uttarakhand & Himachal Pradesh (Himachal touches only **Saharanpur** - shortest border).
- **North-Eastern Boundary: Nepal** (Touches **7 Districts:** Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Bahraich, Shrawasti, Balrampur, Siddharthnagar, Maharajganj — 579 km border).
- **Western Boundary:** Haryana, Delhi (UT), Rajasthan.
- Touches Haryana: Saharanpur, Shamli, Baghpat, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Aligarh, Mathura (6 districts; separated by Yamuna river).
- Touches Delhi: Ghaziabad & Gautam Buddha Nagar.
- Touches Rajasthan: **Mathura & Agra** (2 districts).
- **Southern Boundary: Madhya Pradesh** (Touches **11 Districts:** Agra, Etawah, Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot, Prayagraj, Mirzapur, Sonbhadra — longest inter-state border).
- **South-Eastern Boundary: Chhattisgarh** (Touches only **Sonbhadra**) & **Jharkhand** (Touches only **Sonbhadra**).
- **Eastern Boundary: Bihar** (Touches 7 Districts: Sonbhadra, Chandauli, Ghazipur, Ballia, Deoria, Kushinagar, Maharajganj).

> **Four District Extremes:**
> - **Northernmost District: Saharanpur** (surrounded by Haryana, HP, Uttarakhand)
> - **Southernmost District: Sonbhadra** (**Only district in India bordering 4 states**: MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Bihar)
> - **Easternmost District: Ballia** (wedged into Bihar)
> - **Westernmost District: Shamli**
> - **Largest District by Area: Lakhimpur Kheri** (7,680 sq km)
> - **Smallest District by Area: Hapur** (660 sq km)

2. Drainage System, Rivers, Canals & Wetlands of UP

A. Major Rivers of Uttar Pradesh

River	Entry Point in UP	Exit Point / Confluence	Total Districts in UP & Notes
Ganga	Enters at **Bijnor**	Exits UP at **Ballia** into Bihar	Traverses **28 districts** (~1,450 km in UP). Receives Ramganga at Kannauj, Yamuna at Prayagraj, Gomti at Saidpur (Ghazipur), Ghaghara at Chhapra (Bihar border).
Yamuna	Enters at **Saharanpur** (Faizabad village)	Joins Ganga at **Prayagraj (Triveni Sangam)**	Traverses **19 districts**. Receives Hindon at Noida, Chambal at Pachnada (Etawah), Betwa at Hamirpur, Ken at Chilla (Banda).
Ramganga	Enters at **Bijnor** (near Kalagarh)	Joins Ganga near **Kannauj**	Passes through Corbett National Park; flows via Moradabad, Bareilly.
Gomti	Originates at **Fulhar Lake (Panghaili Jheel), Pilibhit**	Joins Ganga near Saidpur, Ghazipur	**Only major Himalayan tributary originating in the plains of UP**. Lucknow, Sultanpur, Jaunpur situated on its banks.
Ghaghara (Saryu)	Enters near Kheri/Bahraich	Joins Ganga at Chhapra (Bihar)	Originates at Mapchachungo glacier (Tibet); called Karnali in Nepal, Saryu at Ayodhya.
Betwa (Vetravati)	Enters at **Lalitpur**	Joins Yamuna at **Hamirpur**	Originates in Vindhyan range (MP); Rajghat, Parichha, and Matatila dams built on it.
Ken (Karnavati)	Enters at **Banda**	Joins Yamuna at **Chilla (Banda)**	Ken-Betwa river interlinking project is India's first river link project.
Son	Enters and exits in **Sonbhadra**	Joins Ganga near Patna	Originates at Amarkantak plateau (MP).

B. Major Canals & Reservoirs

- **Sharda Canal:** Longest canal network in Uttar Pradesh (originates from Sharda river at Banbasa, India-Nepal border).
- **Upper Ganga Canal:** Constructed by Sir Proby Cautley (1854); originates at Haridwar (Bhimoda).
- **Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar: Largest artificial lake in India**, formed by the **Rihand Dam** on Rihand river at Pipri in **Sonbhadra**.
- **Parichha Dam & Matatila Dam:** Built on **Betwa river** (Jhansi / Lalitpur).
- **Keetham Lake (Sur Sarovar):** Ramsar site in **Agra**.

C. All 10 Ramsar Wetland Sites in Uttar Pradesh

1. **Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora Stretch):** First Ramsar site in UP (designated 2005).
2. **Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary** (Unnao) - renamed Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad Bird Sanctuary.
3. **Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary** (Gonda) - oxbow lake.
4. **Saman Bird Sanctuary** (Mainpuri).
5. **Samaspur Bird Sanctuary** (Rae Bareli).
6. **Sandi Bird Sanctuary** (Hardoi).
7. **Sarsai Nawar Jheel** (Etawah) - sarus crane habitat.
8. **Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)** (Agra).
9. **Haiderpur Wetland** (Muzaffarnagar & Bijnor, designated 2021).
10. **Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary** (Sant Kabir Nagar, designated 2022).

3. National Parks, Tiger Reserves & Wildlife Sanctuaries

- **Only National Park in UP: Dudhwa National Park** (Lakhimpur Kheri, established 1977). Famous for Swamp Deer (Barasingha) and One-horned Rhinoceros reintroduction.
- **Tiger Reserves in UP (4 Total):**
- **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve** (Lakhimpur Kheri - declared 1987)
- **Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** (Pilibhit - declared 2014; won TX2 global award)
- **Amangarh Tiger Reserve** (Bijnor - buffer zone of Jim Corbett NP retained in UP after UK partition)
- **Ranipur Tiger Reserve** (**Chitrakoot** - declared 2022 as UP's 4th and India's 53rd Tiger Reserve, in Bundelkhand region).
- **Elephant Reserve:** Terai Elephant Reserve (TER) established in Lakhimpur Kheri/Pilibhit belt (2022).
- **Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary: Largest wildlife sanctuary in UP** (spread across Meerut, Muzzafarnagar, Bijnor, Amroha, Hapur).
- **Mahavir Swami Wildlife Sanctuary: Smallest wildlife sanctuary in UP** (Lalitpur, ~5.4 sq km).
- **Kachhua (Turtle) Sanctuary:** Varanasi (now shifted to Bhadohi/Prayagraj stretch).
- **State Symbols:** Bird: **Sarus Crane** (*Grus antigone*); Animal: **Swamp Deer** (Barasingha); Tree: **Ashoka**; Flower: **Palash / Dhak** (*Butea monosperma* - Flame of the Forest); Aquatic Animal: **Gangetic Dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*).

4. 9 Agro-Climatic Zones & Agriculture of UP

1. **Tarai Zone:** Bhabhar and Terai belt along foothills (high rainfall, sugarcane, paddy).
2. **Western Plain Zone:** Meerut division, high agricultural productivity (Green Revolution heartland).
3. **Mid-Western Plain Zone:** Bareilly & Moradabad divisions.
4. **South-Western Semi-Arid Zone:** Agra, Mathura, Aligarh (low rainfall, mustard, bajra).
5. **Central Plain Zone:** Lucknow, Kanpur, Ayodhya divisions (alluvial doab).
6. **Bundelkhand Zone:** 7 districts (Jhansi, Lalitpur, Jalaun, Hamirpur, Mahoba, Banda, Chitrakoot) — semi-arid, rocky terrain, pulses, oilseeds.
7. **North-Eastern Plain Zone:** Gorakhpur division (floods, sugarcane, rice).
8. **Eastern Plain Zone:** Varanasi, Azamgarh, Ghazipur, Jaunpur divisions.
9. **Vindhyan Zone:** Mirzapur, Sonbhadra, and southern Chandauli (plateau, red soil, coarse grains).

> **UP Agricultural Ranks in India:**
> - **Rank 1 in:** Total Foodgrain production, Wheat, Sugarcane, Potato, Milk, Mango, Guava, Ethanol production.
> - **Rank 2 in:** Rice (after West Bengal).

5. Minerals & Industrial Belts in Uttar Pradesh

- Uttar Pradesh is generally poor in metallic minerals; mineral wealth is concentrated in the southern plateau districts (Bundelkhand & Vindhyan region):
- **Uranium: Lalitpur** (only district in UP with Uranium occurrences)
- **Copper: Sonrai area, Lalitpur**
- **Limestone: Sonbhadra** (Gurma, Kanach, Kajrahat) & **Mirzapur** (supplies raw material for cement factories at Churk, Dalla, Chunar)
- **Glass Sand (Silica Sand): Shankargarh & Lohgara (Prayagraj)**, Chitrakoot, Banda (derived from disintegration of Vindhyan sandstones)
- **Bauxite (Aluminium ore): Banda, Chitrakoot, Chandauli** (supplies Renukoot Hindalco smelter)
- **Coal: Singrauli (Sonbhadra)** — power capital of India (NTPC plants)
- **Dolomite: Sonbhadra & Banda**
- **Pyrophyllite & Diaspore: Jhansi, Lalitpur, Mahoba, Hamirpur**
- **China Clay: Sonbhadra & Banda**

- **Gold:** Small placer deposits in **Sharda and Ramganga river sands**; Hardi village in Sonbhadra.

6. Revolt of 1857 in Uttar Pradesh: Centres & Leaders

Centre in UP	Indian Leader / Revolutionary	British Officer / Suppressor
Meerut	Sepoys of 3rd Native Cavalry (10 May 1857)	General Hewitt
Delhi / Western UP	General Bakht Khan (from Bareilly)	John Nicholson, Hudson
Kanpur	**Nana Saheb (Dhondu Pant)**, Tantia Tope (Ramchandra Pandurang), Azimullah Khan	Colin Campbell, Havelock
Lucknow	**Begum Hazrat Mahal** (on behalf of minor son Birjis Qadr)	Colin Campbell, Outram, Havelock
Jhansi	**Rani Laxmi Bai (Manikarnika)**	**Sir Hugh Rose** ("*Here lay the woman who was the only man among the rebels*")
Bareilly	**Khan Bahadur Khan**	Vincent Eyre, Colin Campbell
Faizabad (Ayodhya)	**Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah** (*Danka Shah*)	Campbell
Prayagraj (Allahabad)	**Maulvi Liaquat Ali**	Colonel James Neill
Jagdishpur / East UP	Kunwar Singh & Amar Singh	William Taylor, Vincent Eyre
Baghpat	**Shah Mal** (mobilized peasants of Baraut)	Dunlap
Mathura	Kadam Singh, Devi Singh	-
Fatehpur	Hikmatullah	-

7. Cultural Gharanas, Folk Music & Dances

- **Kathak:** Only Classical Dance of North India. Reached its zenith under **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** of Awadh.
- **Lucknow Gharana exponents:** Thakur Prasad, Kalka-Bindadin Maharaj, Achchan Maharaj, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj, **Pt. Birju Maharaj**.
- **Banaras Gharana exponents:** Sitara Devi, Pt. Kishan Maharaj (Tabla), Pt. Samta Prasad (Gudai Maharaj - Tabla), Bismillah Khan (Shehnai - Bharat Ratna 2001).
- **Kirana Gharana:** Founded by **Ustad Abdul Karim Khan & Abdul Wahid Khan** in Muzaffarnagar district (Bhimsen Joshi, Gangubai Hangal belonged to this tradition).
- **Atrali Gharana:** Aligarh.
- **Folk Music Genres:**
- **Rasiya:** Braj region (Mathura, Vrindavan) — themed on Radha-Krishna romance.
- **Kajri:** Mirzapur & Varanasi region — sung during monsoon / rainy season.
- **Birha:** Eastern UP (Bhojpuri belt) — heroic and narrative folklore.
- **Alha:** Bundelkhand region (Mahoba) — martial epic commemorating heroic deeds of Alha & Udal.
- **Chaiti & Hori:** Purvanchal & Braj region.
- **Folk Dances of UP:**
- **Charkula Dance: Braj region** — women balance a multi-tiered wooden pyramid with 108 oil lamps on their heads.
- **Karma Dance: Sonbhadra & Mirzapur** (performed by tribal communities like Kharwar).

- **Pai Danda & Diwari: Bundelkhand** (stick dance reminiscent of Raas Leela).
- **Nautanki:** Traditional folk theatre of UP (Hathras & Kanpur schools).

8. High-Yield One District One Product (ODOP) Master Match-List

District in UP	Official ODOP Product / Heritage Craft
Agra	Leather Goods & Footwear; Petha
Aligarh	**Locks and Hardware**
Amroha	**Musical Instruments (Dholak)**
Ayodhya	**Jaggery (Gud)**
Azamgarh	**Black Clay Pottery (Nizamabad)** — GI Tagged
Bhadohi	**Handmade Woollen Carpets (Dhurries)** — GI Tagged (*Carpet City*)
Chandauli	**Black Rice (Chak-Hao / Adamchini Rice)**
Farrukhabad	**Block Printing & Zari-Zardozi**
Firozabad	**Glassware & Glass Bangles** (*Suhag Nagari*)
Gorakhpur	**Terracotta Crafts** — GI Tagged
Kannauj	**Perfume (Attar) & Essential Oils** (*Grasse of the East*)
Kanpur Nagar	**Leather Products** (*Cawnpore Leather City*)
Lucknow	**Chikan Craft (Chikankari) & Zardozi** — GI Tagged
Mathura	Sanitary Fittings; Peda
Meerut	**Sports Goods** (*Sports Capital of India*)
Moradabad	**Metal Crafts / Brassware** (*Peetal Nagari*)
Muzaffarnagar	**Jaggery (Gud)**
Pilibhit	**Wooden Flute (Bansuri)** (*Bansuri Nagari*)
Pratapgarh	**Aonla (Indian Gooseberry) Products**
Saharanpur	**Wooden Carving Crafts**
Sambhal	**Horn & Bone Handicrafts**
Varanasi	**Banarasi Silk Sarees & Pink Meenakari**